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in the embedded space, there are some areas of concern, like the absence of a mature electronic prototyping and electronic manufacturing ecosystem, restrictive hardware import laws, inadequate infrastructure for testing and certifications, and lack of industry-specific talent," shares R. Ramanan, managing director and chief executive officer, CMC.

Adds Neeraj Varma, director-sales, Xilinx India, "What India isn't well known for is India-made products. There is a recognition for Indian services but not for its products. Within India, the market is huge. There is enough opportunity available locally, which needs to be tapped rather than depending on imports."

While India should focus on ensuring that it continues to innovate, innovations need not be in terms of technology only—we should work towards developing new business and revenue models as well.

Today, India is one of the preferred destinations for semiconductor R&D mainly due to the availability of highly skilled and cost-competitive resources for high-quality work. Still, there are many cases where small, risky, strategic, complex or high-tech projects including highly skilled tasks of analysis and design are not outsourced.

"The situation is not very competitive when we talk about semiconductor manufacturing. It is quite complicated as it requires high-end techno-

logical expertise for manufacturing on latest process nodes and also robust infrastructural support like uninterrupted supply of power and distilled water, good road network and global air connectivity. Also, a fab requires co-location of the ecosystem to be efficient, which means all the players in the manufacturing ecosystem—all raw material suppliers and support infrastructure providers—should be located near the manufacturing base for easy access. Apart from this, as fabs are capital-intensive, these need to be fully loaded (utilised) most of the time to be profitable," informs Ganesh. ●

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